



Communist firepower

Made in China for the NVA, the CHICOM Type-50 antitank grenade was a copy of the Soviet RPG-2. "CHICOM" was a US intelligence term for Chinese technology—US soldiers used it as pejorative slang for captured equipment.

New broom

General Truong reorganized the ARVN defenses. The First Division, which Truong had once led, was far more organized in its defense of Hue, the next assumed target. Difficulties of supply meant that the NVA lacked the weight of artillery and armor it had enjoyed along the DMZ. When ARVN defenses held to the west and north of Hue, Truong moved to stabilize the line along the My Chanh River, about halfway between Quang Tri and Hue.

By May 13, ARVN forces had regained enough confidence to make further attacks and they gradually expanded their efforts west and north of the city of Hue. On June 14, General Truong presented a plan for the recapture of Quang Tri and reached the town on July 4. Both the assault and the defense were fierce, with house-to-house fighting. The Vietnamese Marine Division replaced the Airborne on July 27. NVA soldiers began to call the town Hamburger city for the way new men arrived at night but were dead before dawn. The South Vietnamese fought them every step of the way and took the last positions in Quang Tri's citadel on September 15. With both armies exhausted and the city in ruins, the offensive in Quang Tri province was over.